campaign. Prague, the capital city of Czechoslovakia was receiving a host of visitors from the Soviet Union, Cuba and India to explore business opportunities in various sectors during this time. The strengthening of business ties provided a way to gain a foothold in the country and establish safe houses. The Indians quoted a market survey that showed a demand for a wide range of textiles, ready-made garments, hosiery, goods made of natural leather, sports goods, jewellery and cosmetics. Many Indian firms signed contracts with state agencies for regular supplies of spices, tea and other foodstuff. The president of Czechoslovakia, Gustav Husak, who became the long-term secretary general of the Communist Party of Czechoslovakia, was a bitter critic of imperialism and his close ties with Moscow were an added advantage for the Indian intelligence organisation.

But India was not the only country running spies from Prague. France, just a thousand kilometres away, was equally interested in expanding espionage operations through its attaches. In mid-February 1981, two French defence attaches were caught spying, which led to the expulsion of diplomats from both sides. It was a nerve-racking time for the Indian spies who were launching operations in Europe and Africa. But they survived despite little assistance from the officials of the diplomatic service.

R&AW and its operatives have successfully conducted several operations without inviting much attention, but certain areas in the everchanging dynamics of security remain vulnerable. According to Narasimhan, the R&AW, like the CIA, wants a hand in everything. Even with a friendly government, the R&AW needs to play both sides—the ruling party and the opposition—to ensure it remains unaffected by electoral outcomes in the